

HOUSE No. 2057**The Commonwealth of Massachusetts**

PRESENTED BY:

Steven George Xiarhos and Richard G. Wells, Jr.*To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:*

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act ensuring the safety and dignity of first responders (Halo Act).

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Steven George Xiarhos</i>	<i>5th Barnstable</i>	<i>1/9/2025</i>
<i>Steven J. Ouellette</i>	<i>8th Bristol</i>	<i>1/13/2025</i>
<i>Ryan C. Fattman</i>	<i>Worcester and Hampden</i>	<i>1/25/2025</i>
<i>Marc T. Lombardo</i>	<i>22nd Middlesex</i>	<i>1/25/2025</i>
<i>Joseph D. McKenna</i>	<i>18th Worcester</i>	<i>2/11/2025</i>
<i>Michael J. Soter</i>	<i>8th Worcester</i>	<i>3/25/2025</i>
<i>Donald R. Berthiaume, Jr.</i>	<i>5th Worcester</i>	<i>3/25/2025</i>
<i>John J. Marsi</i>	<i>6th Worcester</i>	<i>3/25/2025</i>
<i>Kelly W. Pease</i>	<i>4th Hampden</i>	<i>3/25/2025</i>
<i>Kenneth P. Sweezey</i>	<i>6th Plymouth</i>	<i>3/25/2025</i>
<i>Michael O. Moore</i>	<i>Second Worcester</i>	<i>3/25/2025</i>
<i>Hannah Kane</i>	<i>11th Worcester</i>	<i>4/4/2025</i>
<i>Bruce E. Tarr</i>	<i>First Essex and Middlesex</i>	<i>4/4/2025</i>
<i>Donald H. Wong</i>	<i>9th Essex</i>	<i>4/4/2025</i>
<i>Steven S. Howitt</i>	<i>4th Bristol</i>	<i>4/4/2025</i>
<i>Marcus S. Vaughn</i>	<i>9th Norfolk</i>	<i>4/28/2025</i>
<i>Margaret R. Scarsdale</i>	<i>1st Middlesex</i>	<i>4/28/2025</i>
<i>Kelly A. Dooner</i>	<i>Third Bristol and Plymouth</i>	<i>4/28/2025</i>

<i>Patrick M. O'Connor</i>	<i>First Plymouth and Norfolk</i>	<i>5/10/2025</i>
<i>James C. Arena-DeRosa</i>	<i>8th Middlesex</i>	<i>5/15/2025</i>
<i>Justin Thurber</i>	<i>5th Bristol</i>	<i>2/11/2026</i>

HOUSE No. 2057

By Representatives Xiarhos of Barnstable and Wells of Milton, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 2057) of Steven George Xiarhos, Steven J. Ouellette and others for legislation to establish penalties for the intent to impede or interfere, threaten or harass first responders performing such duties. The Judiciary.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act ensuring the safety and dignity of first responders (Halo Act).

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION ONE. Chapter 271 of the General Laws is hereby amended by adding the
2 following section:-

3 Section 52. (a) As used in this section, the following words shall have the following
4 meanings unless the context clearly requires otherwise:-

5 “First responder”, shall include any law enforcement officer, a paid, call, reserve or
6 volunteer firefighter, a paid, call, reserve or volunteer emergency medical technician, or any
7 other person whose usual and regular duties include rendering assistance at the scene of a crime,
8 accident or other emergency.

9 “Harass”, means to willfully engage in a course of conduct directed at a first responder
10 which intentionally causes substantial emotional distress in that first responder and serves no
11 legitimate purpose.

12 (b) No person, after receiving a verbal warning not to approach from a person he or she
13 knows or reasonably should know is a first responder and who is engaged in the lawful
14 performance of a legal duty, shall knowingly and willfully violate such warning and approach or
15 remain within 25 feet of the first responder with the intent to impede or interfere with the first
16 responder's ability to perform such duty, threaten the first responder with physical harm, or
17 harass the first responder.

18 (c) Any violation of this section shall be punishable by a fine of not more than \$1,000 for
19 the first offense, and for each and every subsequent offense, by a fine or not more than \$5,000 or
20 imprisonment not exceeding one year, or both.